

JAMES M. GAVIN

TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: NO RETREAT (battlefield made with vidIQ; Gavin's real public-domain US Army photo added on top)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Gavin-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 597 MB)
Download	https://gofile.io/d/25hccRAQ
Length	14:07
Voice	Kokoro (free AI voice, am_michael)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit zoom sound, original effects

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: 26 Canvas Boats
0:55	Who Was James Gavin?
1:56	Move 1: Biazza Ridge
3:24	Paratroopers vs Tiger Tanks
5:51	Move 2: The La Fiere Causeway
7:52	9 June: The Charge Across the Causeway
9:25	Move 3: Market Garden
11:02	The Waal Crossing
12:47	Legacy

Key frames



2. Title and thumbnail

Title (locked, vidIQ score 93)

Paratroopers vs Tiger Tanks: James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves

Alternatives (vidIQ scores):

- The General Who Jumped Into Battle 4 Times: James Gavin's Top 3 Tactical Moves (90)
- The General Who Jumped First: James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves (89)

Why this thumbnail

Same picture formula as every Tactical Genius thumbnail: a dark aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and white arrows on the left, the commander on the right, and a red brush banner bottom-left. The text is what decides the click: 1-3 words, readable with zero context. **NO RETREAT** is type 1 (the hero's defiance): Gavin's order on Biazza Ridge was that they were staying on the ridge no matter what (no quote marks: it is not his exact wording). It makes the same promise as the title (paratroopers vs Tiger tanks).

Alternative for YouTube's Test & compare: **TIGERS INCOMING** (type 3, ominous stakes).



Checked: Biazza Ridge and Ponte Dirillo labels, Tiger tanks (correct: a Tiger company of the Hermann Göring Division was there), blue paratrooper blocks on the ridge, red German blocks below. The portrait is Gavin's real US Army photo (public domain), not an AI likeness. Note: the photo shows him later as a major general (two stars); at Biazza Ridge he was a colonel.

Before uploading: check the thumbnail at small size on a phone.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound and image licences require them.

Paratroopers vs Tiger Tanks: James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves

Twenty-six canvas boats. Two hundred and sixty men. A river three hundred metres wide, in broad daylight, with German guns waiting on the far bank. The general who sent them had done this kind of thing before.

In this video we break down James Gavin's three greatest tactical moves: the stand on Biazza Ridge against Tiger tanks in Sicily (1943), the charge across the La Fièrè causeway in Normandy (1944), and the Waal River crossing at Nijmegen during Operation Market Garden (1944).

Lead from the front. Take the ground that decides the battle. Attack where the enemy is sure you cannot.

Which commander should we cover next? Tell us in the comments.

CHAPTERS

0:00 Intro: 26 Canvas Boats
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7:52 9 June: The Charge Across the Causeway
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SOURCES

James M. Gavin, "Jump into Sicily" (account of Biazza Ridge, American Heritage) and On to Berlin: Battles of an Airborne Commander 1943-1946 (1978)
Albert N. Garland & Howard McGaw Smyth, Sicily and the Surrender of Italy (US Army Center of Military History)
Utah Beach to Cherbourg (US Army, American Forces in Action series)
Phil Nordyke, All American All the Way: The Combat History of the 82nd Airborne Division in World War II
Cornelius Ryan, A Bridge Too Far (1974)
Charles B. MacDonald, The Siegfried Line Campaign (US Army Center of Military History)

CREDITS

Maps: original animations; terrain from Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data).

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0 License.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots" by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by Kostrava (CC0), via Freesound. Zoom sound: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License). Other sound effects: original.

Archival film: public domain (US National Archives: Army Signal Corps films and Army Combat Bulletins, US Navy films, Office of War Information "United News" newsreels, Universal Newsreels, Army Air Forces "D-Day Minus One"), via the Internet Archive.

Images: public domain (US Army Signal Corps, US Army Military History Institute, US Department of Defense, Library of Congress / Alfred T. Palmer, JFK Library / Abbie Rowe), via Wikimedia Commons and the Library of Congress.

Narration voice: AI-generated (Kokoro TTS). Maps: original animations.
Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#JamesGavin #82ndAirborne #MilitaryHistory

4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, history documentary, World War II, WW2, James Gavin, James M. Gavin, 82nd Airborne Division, paratroopers, Battle of Biazza Ridge, Operation Husky, La Fiere causeway, Normandy, D-Day, Operation Market Garden, Waal crossing, Nijmegen, greatest military tactics, animated battle map
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Biazza, Ponte Dirillo, La Fièrè, Merderet, Cauquigny, Nijmegen, Waal, Julian Cook)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail battlefield is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which commander should we cover next? Ridgway, Puller, Rommel, Slim...?
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720).
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 4%, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (single secondary source or disputed; see research/FACT_NOTES.md):

- "No other American general made four combat jumps" (Wikipedia wording).
- Gavin to Capt. Rae, "All right, you've got to go." (HistoryNet; shown in quote marks).
- Julian Cook praying "Hail Mary, full of grace" while paddling (Ryan / secondary sources).
- "None of the paratroopers had ever used one" (the canvas boats).
- Biazza Ridge casualties: Gavin's own count (about 50 dead, 100+ wounded); the Ponte Dirillo memorial lists 39 names.
- Waal crossing wounded: shown as 100+ (sources give ~100 to 151).
- Map positions (Biazza Ridge crest, the La Fièrè flood edge, the crossing point) are approximate, read from terrain.